

P.P.U. International Montessori House Sarajevo

PROCEDURE

in
the event of a bomb threat in the
school premises

Sarajevo, September 2024.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. INTRODUCTION.....	1
1.1. Purpose of the procedure	1
1.2. Scope of Application	1
1.3. Responsibility.....	1
2. DETAILED STEPS OF THE PROCEDURE.....	2
2.1. Receiving a bomb threat	2
2.2. Notifying the Director	2
2.3. Calling the Police and Other Competent Authorities.....	2
2.4. Activating the Crisis Team.....	3
2.5. Alerting staff and organizing evacuation.....	4
2.6. Preparing children for evacuation	4
2.7. Evacuation of premises.....	5
2.8. Actions at the evacuation site	5
2.9. Notifying Parents	6
2.10. Director's actions	7
2.11. Inspection of the facility.....	8
2.12. Returning to the kindergarten	8
2.13. Psychological Support.....	8
2.14. Reporting.....	8
3. FINAL PROVISIONS	9

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1. Purpose of the procedure

This procedure provides comprehensive guidelines for responding to a bomb threat in the premises of the P.P.U. International Montessori House Sarajevo (hereinafter: IMH). Its primary purpose is to ensure the safety of children, staff, and all those present, through a properly organized, rapid, and safe evacuation and the timely notification of the competent authorities in order to avoid potential threats to life and property.

In emergency situations, such as bomb threats, every decision must be carefully considered and in accordance with safety standards, in order to avoid panic and ensure a smooth evacuation.

Timely response can reduce damage and prevent unwanted consequences.

1.2. Scope of Application

This procedure applies to all persons present in the kindergarten, including children, parents, staff, educators, support staff, and administrative workers. It applies to all areas of the kindergarten – classrooms, offices, hallways, bathrooms, kitchen, dining room, as well as all outdoor areas used for children's activities.

Each person within the facility must be informed of the procedure and is required to follow the prescribed steps if a threat occurs. Regular simulations and staff training are crucial to preparing all participants.

1.3. Responsibility

Responsibility for the implementation, regular review, and updating of this procedure rests with the director of the kindergarten. The director must ensure that every member of staff is familiar with the procedure and complies with all measures in the event of crisis situations. The director is also responsible for conducting regular training and evacuation exercises to ensure that staff are prepared to respond in case of emergencies. Any person who receives a bomb threat is required to notify the director and then proceed according to this procedure.

2. DETAILED STEPS OF THE PROCEDURE

2.1. Receiving a bomb threat

2.1.1. If any person in the kindergarten receives information about a bomb threat (by phone, email, or other means), they are obligated to notify the director of the kindergarten immediately.

The reaction time at this stage is critical, and it is important not to delay the transfer of information.

2.1.2. The person who receives the threat must try to obtain as much information as possible about the threat, where the bomb is allegedly placed, when it was placed, what the suspicious package looks like, and whether there is any other relevant detail. This data may significantly facilitate the actions of the competent authorities.

2.2. Notifying the Director

2.2.1. As soon as information about the threat is received, the director must be notified without delay. In the director's absence, the incident is reported to the deputy or person in charge of crisis situations.

2.2.2. The person who received the threat transmits all collected information to the director, which enables an assessment of the situation and taking appropriate measures.

2.3. Calling the Police and Other Competent Authorities

2.3.1. After receiving information about the threat, the director immediately calls the police at 122 or at +387 33 286 700.

2.3.2. The director should provide the police with all available information about the situation, including the name of the school, address, number of present students and employees, and any other relevant information to ensure a quick and effective response.

2.4. Activating the Crisis Team

The office manager and pedagogue immediately alert all educators in the kindergarten using pre-prepared communication channels, including email, Viber groups, or the kindergarten's internal alert system, as needed. In the Viber group of educators, a message created and saved in preparation for this occasion is sent. The Viber message is as follows:



1. **Toddleri idu prvi**, a za njima odmah i predškolarci.
2. Idite u **Veliki Park ispod Goethe Instituta**.
3. Menadžer ureda šalje **e-mail roditeljima** da dođu u Veliki Park.
4. Pedagog i spremačica -> ponesite **bidone s vodom i čaše** koje stoje na porti.
5. U zgradi ostaje samo direktor do dolaska policije.

*** POLAKO I BEZ PANIKE ***

The content of this message is in the Bosnian language so that all employees can immediately and fully understand it as soon as they receive it and promptly start responding in accordance with this procedure. Here is the translation of the message into English:

BOMB IN KINDERGARTEN

1. **Toddlers go first**, followed immediately by preschoolers.
2. Go to **Veliki Park below the Goethe Institute**.
3. The office manager sends an **email to parents** to come to Veliki Park.
4. Pedagogues and cleaning staff -> bring **water bottles and glasses** that are at the main entrance.
5. Only the director remains in the building until the police arrive.

BE CALM AND DO NOT PANIC

2.4.1. The message clearly indicates the urgency of the situation and provides instructions for evacuation, to ensure all employees understand the seriousness of the situation.

2.4.2. Team members communicate with each other by phone/mobile phone and act in synchronized manner in accordance with the steps prescribed by this procedure. In exceptional cases, the team can meet at the kindergarten's entrance, as a designated safe location in the kindergarten, where they will discuss further steps and plan the evacuation.

2.5. Alerting staff and organizing evacuation

2.5.1. The office manager or director sends an urgent notice to all employees through internal channels (email, Viber) about the current situation and the start of the evacuation. Employees must be clearly informed about the threat, evacuation procedures, and the location where the children will be evacuated (Veliki Park below the Goethe Institute).

2.5.2. All employees are instructed to remain calm, act in accordance with the plan, and not cause panic among the children.

2.6. Preparing children for evacuation

2.6.1. From the moment the bomb threat is received, educators and staff should begin to prepare children for evacuation:

- 1. Soothe the children and explain the situation appropriately, avoiding panic.**
- 2. Organize children into smaller groups or pairs, ensuring that every child is with someone.**
- 3. Check the attendance of all children and make sure that no one is left behind.**
- 4. Toddlers are evacuated first, followed by preschoolers.**

2.6.2. The cleaning staff and the pedagogue must bring water bottles and glasses which are located at the main entrance of the kindergarten for this occasion.

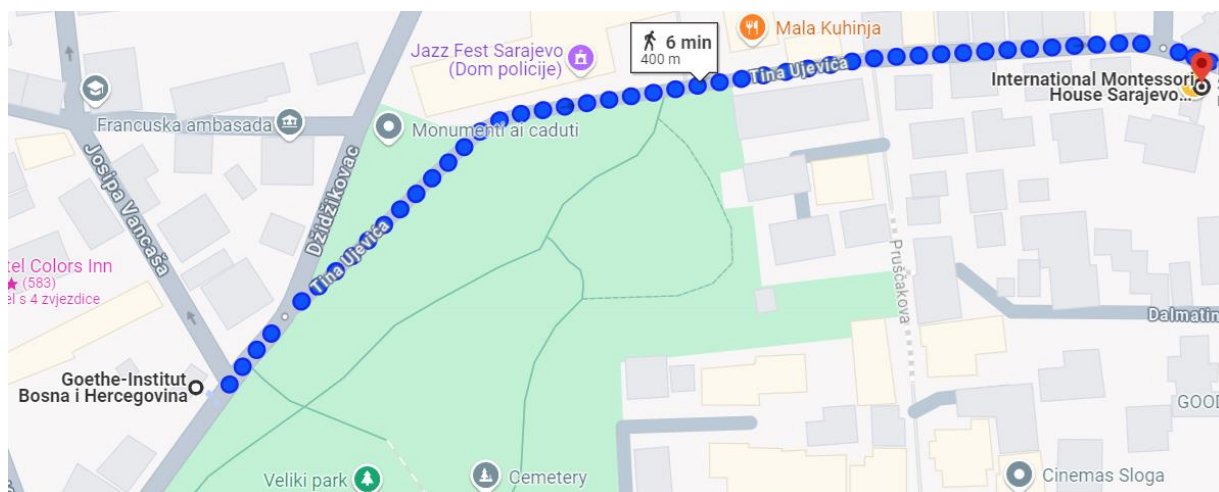
2.6.3. Everyone takes with them only the essentials, while the rest of the things are left in the kindergarten until return.

2.7. Evacuation of premises

2.7.1. Evacuation is carried out immediately after the team is alerted and all the children are ready. The previously determined evacuation plan, which includes a safe route to the exit, must be followed.

2.7.2. All children are evacuated to a pre-arranged safe location, which in this case is Veliki Park below the Goethe Institute, where they will gather.

2.7.3. Educators guide their groups of children along the shortest and safest route to Veliki Park, watching out for all possible hazards on the way and maintaining order.



Map image with a marked evacuation route

2.8. Actions at the evacuation site

2.8.1. Upon arrival at the evacuation site, educators and support staff must recheck the attendance of all children and students, ensuring that each child is safe and cared for.

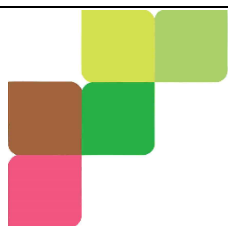
2.8.2. Organizing the distribution of water and basic necessities is of utmost importance in order to ensure hydration and calm the children.

2.8.3. The children gather in small groups, and educators provide them with emotional support, talking about the situation, and helping them feel safe.

2.9. Notifying Parents

2.9.1. The office manager sends a pre-prepared email to all parents and guardians to inform them of the situation and then joins the evacuation.

2.9.2. The alert email is already prepared for sending and looks like this:



BOMBA U VRTIĆU
Poštovani roditelji/staratelji,

ponovo smo primili e-mail da je u vrtiću postavljena bomba.

U trenutku dok čitate ovu poruku **DJECA i ODGAJATELJI** su **DOBRO i SIGURNO** i evakuisani su na lokalitet **Veliki Park, ispod Goethe Instituta**.

Ministarstvo unutrašnjih poslova Kantona Sarajevo je odmah informisano kao i odjeljenje za kriminalističku tehniku i operativne radnje su u toku.

Molimo vas da čim prije dođete na lokalitet Veliki Park ispod Goethe Instituta i preuzmete vaše dijete, budući da je u pitanju vanredna situacija i ne možemo znati koliko će trajati pregled vrtića.

Odmah nakon prestanka opasnosti bićete obaviješteni.

Kontakt u slučaju hitnosti:

Davor Mulalić +387 61 787 331

Azra Morić +387 61 614 358

BOMB IN KINDERGARTEN

Dear Parents/Guardians,

we have once again received an email stating that a bomb has been placed in the kindergarten.

At the time you are reading this message, **the CHILDREN and TEACHERS** are **SAFE and SECURE**, and they have been evacuated to the location of **Veliki Park, below the Goethe Institute**.

The Ministry of Internal Affairs of Sarajevo Canton has been immediately informed, as well as the Department of Criminalistics, and operations are currently underway.

Please come to Veliki Park below the Goethe Institute as soon as possible to pick up your child, as this is an emergency situation, and we cannot predict how long the inspection of the kindergarten will take.

You will be notified immediately once the danger has passed.

Emergency contacts:

Davor Mulalić +387 61 787 331

Azra Morić +387 61 614 358

2.9.3. In the Bcc. section of the email, there is an already entered email of **the USA embassy** (SarajevoRSOAmericans@state.gov) and the office manager adds emails of the parents/guardians from the address book, and sends the email.

2.10. Director's actions

2.10.1. The director stays in the kindergarten until the arrival of the police and other competent services in order to provide all the necessary information and documentation.

2.10.2. The director keeps records of the present children and educators, to ensure everyone is registered and knows who was in the kindergarten during the incident.

2.10.3. If needed, the director can contact the crisis team and request additional assistance or support from other institutions.

2.11. Inspection of the facility

2.11.1. After the competent services arrive, a detailed inspection is carried out in all areas of the kindergarten, including classrooms, hallways, dining area, kitchen, and other common areas.

2.11.2. The director cooperates with the police, providing them with all information about suspicious objects or situations within the kindergarten.

2.11.3. The director supervises and encourages the inspection of all areas of the kindergarten by members of the criminal investigation department.

2.12. Returning to the kindergarten

2.12.1. Once the police and other competent services have confirmed that the area is safe, the director can make a decision about returning children and employees to the kindergarten.

2.12.2. All employees must be informed about the continuation of activities in the kindergarten and the safety measures that will be applied after the incident.

2.12.3. Children can return only with their educators, and a short meeting will be held at the kindergarten to explain the situation and provide support.

2.13. Psychological Support

2.13.1. Psychological support will be organized for the children and staff affected by the situation in collaboration with relevant experts, including psychologists as needed.

2.13.2. The pedagogue and the director will be available for conversations and support at the gathering place or, if necessary, in the kindergarten's premises, thus ensuring emotional support to all who were exposed to stress.

2.14. Reporting

2.14.1. After the incident, the director prepares a comprehensive report on the event, including all steps taken during the incident, communication with the competent authorities, and assistance provided.

2.14.2. The report is submitted to the relevant institutions (MUP, KDZ, etc.) and retained as official evidence, and the data is used for future analysis and improvement of procedures.

3. FINAL PROVISIONS

This procedure enters into force on the date of adoption and obligates all employees to respect it. Regular updating and training of employees will be carried out as needed in order to ensure an effective response in the event of crisis situations.

Date of adoption: 25.09.2024. year

Director:



